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6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

Franklin Templeton

Cannon Place, 78 Cannon Street

London EC4N 6HL

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Futures Rotational Graduate Program – Investment Management (2027) in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Franklin Templeton's Futures Program, which rotates graduates across investment teams that use data and digital tools alongside fundamental research, suits an economist whose research runs on code.

My academic work centres on a question asset managers answer every day: what is a return worth once its risk is understood? I tested CAPM on 704 anomaly portfolios across 56 countries and found it fails jointly in 48 of 52, with momentum and value earning the most persistent alphas. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on storage, market and news-based data, and tests whether better risk forecasts improve a volatility-targeted futures strategy, a question that matters to any portfolio with commodity exposure.

Asset management appeals to me because it rewards a process that holds up over years rather than a single good call, and because the money belongs to people relying on that process. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I led weekly research sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC and published weekly research notes for members from outside finance. That work taught me that a sound view is only half the job; it also has to be explained clearly to the people who rely on it.

Franklin Templeton stands out to me because of its breadth across public and private markets and its continuing commitment to Scotland, where its Edinburgh office houses several portfolio management teams as the Martin Currie teams move under ClearBridge and Franklin Equity Group. A rotational programme would let me test where my strengths fit best, from the factor research behind my CAPM study to the risk forecasting in my dissertation.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan